

Figure 4.22 Curtains

4.8.2 Depositional Landforms due to Ground water

The following depositional features are formed within caves.

1. Curtains

Rain water drips from long crack in a cave roof forms a continuous strip of calcites. It is called as curtains.

2. Stalactite

Drops of water containing dissolved limestone seep down through cracks in the cave roof. Drops of water lose carbon dioxide and deposit calcite. Overtime deposition of calcite forms pillars hanging down from the roof of the cave. It is called as stalactite and where the stalactite stretches towards the sides are known as Helactites.

3. Stalagmite

Deposition of calcite forming icicles growing upward from the cave floor is called as stalagmite.

Stalactites are calcium carbonate deposits hanging as icicles while Stalagmites are calcium carbonate deposits which rise up from the floor.

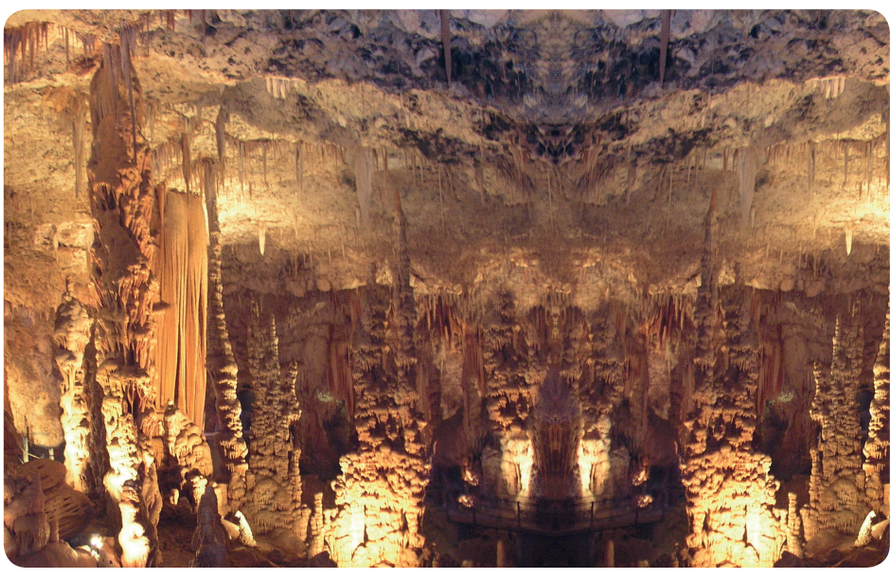


Figure 4.23 Stalagmite, stalactite, and pillar

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